

Subjects were then asked to note where the spot on the clock was when they had the urge, or desire, to flex. This was used to record the time of, as Libet thought of it, the subject's **conscious willing** to flex his or her hand. Libet called this the "**W time.**"

This was then compared with the time at which certain brain events, measured by EEG, occurred in the subject. These were brain events which other experiments had shown to precede certain intentional actions. The increased brain activity which occurs prior to a certain sort of intentional action is called that action's **readiness potential**. Libet called the times at which subjects showed a readiness potential for flexing their hands “**RP-onset times.**”

The W time and the RP -onset time were then compared with the ‘zero time’ — the time at which the subject’s hand actually flexed.



replies to
Libet

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the Libet
experiments



is free will
an important
good?

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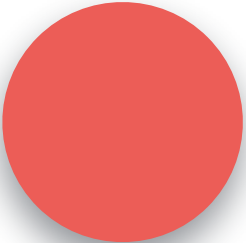
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will prosper by contemporary neuroscience.

determinism. Our topic today is much more recent challenge to free

In ancient times, philosophers worried about the challenge to free will from fate. After

the birth of modern physics, many worried about the challenges it would bring from

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the Libet experiments



